U6 Steering the ship

Unit overview

This unit offers an in-depth understanding of the Communist Party of China (CPC) and its crucial role in shaping the nation's historical trajectory and future. The Understanding China section examines how the CPC has led the Chinese people to national independence, prosperity, and modernization, underscoring its commitment to serving the people through acts of bravery, resilience, and innovation. In Exploring the world, global political systems are introduced, emphasizing how the political party systems of various countries are tailored to align with their unique national conditions. Additionally, in Communicating with the world, Ss are asked to write an argumentative essay, specifically addressing the theme "Why the CPC: The choice of history and the people." The essay writing project encourages Ss to engage critically with the materials, present well-supported arguments, and reflect on the CPC's continued relevance in modern China.

思政元素清单

校园资料仓

Understanding China — Viewing

- 通过了解中国近代史的屈辱与抗争，激发学生的爱国情怀，增强民族自豪感和责任感。
- 在面对困难和挑战时，保持坚定的信念和积极的态度，为实现中华民族的伟大复兴而努力奋斗。
- 中国共产党的领导地位是历史和人民的选择。

Understanding China — Reading

- 在百年奋斗历史过程中，中国共产党展现出迎难而上、开拓创新的精神品质。
- 党的使命是为人民服务，实现中华民族的伟大复兴。

Exploring the world — Reading

- 一个国家的政党制度取决于其国情和历史文化传统，各国应根据自身实际情况选择适合的政党制度。
- 中国共产党领导的多党合作和政治协商制度为世界政党制度提供了“中国方案”。
- 应坚定制度自信。

单元开篇

Quote

全面建设社会主义现代化国家，实现中华民族伟大复兴，关键在党。

——2022 年 10 月 16 日，习近平在中国共产党第二十次全国代表大会上的报告

Key facts about China

The following key facts are of great significance for understanding the organizational structure and membership composition of the CPC, and its active role in the world.

Key fact 1: The CPC's extensive contacts with political parties and organizations worldwide demonstrate its active role in international affairs and its efforts to promote global cooperation and exchange. These contacts help the CPC to understand different political systems and ideologies, and to share its experiences and ideas with other parties, contributing to the development of a more peaceful and prosperous world.

Key fact 2: The large number of grassroots organizations indicates the CPC's extensive presence and influence at the local level. As the operational foundation of the Party, these bodies ensure effective policy implementation and public engagement across communities. They play a crucial role in connecting the Party with the people and promoting social stability and development. Here, the English terms correspond to the following Chinese structures: grassroots organizations (基层党组织), primary Party committees (基层党委), general branches (总支部), and branches (支部).

校园资料仓

Key fact 3: The fact illustrates the composition of CPC membership, highlighting the Party's vitality, inclusiveness, and its strong ties to the working class and farmers, who are the fundamental forces of the country.

***T can guide Ss to access the digital textbook for the latest information and data on Ucampus.**

Teaching suggestions

Step 1: Begin by introducing the unit title. Ask Ss to reflect on the quote from President Xi Jinping's speech and guide them to think about the ways leadership plays a crucial role in a nation's development. Encourage Ss to use both successful and unsuccessful examples from home and abroad to illustrate their views.

Step 2: Have Ss review the key facts about the CPC. Divide Ss into small groups and have them explore the implications of the CPC's inclusivity and its growing global significance.

Step 3: Invite Ss to review the Scenario section and encourage them to brainstorm initial ideas for their article to be submitted to the column. Ask them to share their thoughts with the class. Based on their input, T should identify any gaps between Ss'

existing knowledge and the knowledge required to complete the task. This will enable T to tailor their instruction to address these specific areas more effectively in subsequent lessons.

Step 4: Outline the unit's learning objectives and explain how this unit enhances Ss understanding of the CPC's role in national independence and prosperity. Emphasize how this unit helps Ss appreciate the strengths of socialism with Chinese characteristics, with a focus on how the CPC's leadership is the cornerstone of these strengths.

校园资料仓

Understanding China

The two materials in this section explore the founding of the CPC and its enduring impact on the country's development. The video delves into China's struggles before the founding of the CPC, showcasing the crises faced by the nation and how the Party emerged as a solution. It highlights the pivotal moment when the CPC was founded and its unique strategy, focusing on the working class and farmers. The reading text complements this narrative by describing the CPC's achievements over the past century, from liberation to national rejuvenation, emphasizing its continuous commitment to serving the people and driving China's modernization.

The key teaching focus is to help Ss understand the CPC's crucial role in China's history and its ongoing impact. A critical goal is for Ss to draw connections between historical events and the CPC's leadership, while reflecting on how the Party's vision aligns with China's current and future development.

Both materials reflect the CPC's unwavering commitment to the people's welfare and national rejuvenation. The video illustrates the concept of "serving the people" by highlighting the CPC's focus on the needs of the majority – workers and farmers – while the reading emphasizes the CPC's role in fostering economic prosperity, technological advancements, and global influence. These examples align with the principles of socialism with Chinese characteristics.

校园资料仓

Viewing

Before viewing

Reference answers

1 e
2 b
3 c
4 a
5 d

Scripts

Why choose the CPC?

Deep crisis

Since the defeat in the Opium War, China had become prey to Western colonizers empowered by the Industrial Revolution. Forced concessions and indemnities ended up on the shoulders of ordinary Chinese.

Patriotic attempts

Fortunately, there was no lack of men and women who kept trying to save the country they loved. Those patriots looked at the already successful attempts in the West to make changes to China. They tried to push for reform and build a constitutional

monarchy, but failed. They were able to build a democratic republic through revolution, but it did not last long.

Turning point

On May 4, 1919, patriotic students in Beijing took to the streets to protest the government that caved in to the unreasonable demands of imperialist powers after World War I. The protest soon spread to more than 100 cities across China, with huge support from workers who went on strike. During the protests, intellectuals influenced by Marxism after the October Revolution in Russia were touched by the power of workers in the fight to save China. Early Communist groups started to sprout up in Chinese cities with a large working class.

New Party

In 1921, the First National Congress of the CPC announced the official founding of the Party. By then, there were more than 50 CPC members across the country, but this small political party had the answer to the question: What's the way out for China?

By then, Mao Zedong had found that a tenant peasant could save no more than 20 yuan after a full year of hard work in several field studies in Hunan Province, which meant peasants in China had a harder life than farm cattle. But the needs of those peasants, the silent majority of Chinese people, were rarely noticed by previous reformers until the CPC. Such realization echoes the essence of Marxism, which is to create a society without any exploitation. The Party soon worked to mobilize peasants, paving the way for a unique revolutionary strategy of surrounding cities from the countryside, and eventually established a New China. The CPC's decision to choose Marxism as its guiding theory was a wise one, one that understood the misery and capacity of the many workers and peasants in China.

校园资料仓

"And [the] only thing that draw[s] people together is by addressing [the] majority people's concern. When you sided with the overwhelming majority of the people, the peasantry, the workers, people in lower [classes], you will get their support."

The people know who best serves their interests and therefore choose the CPC as the leadership to win independence. In Chinese, people say *xuan de dui* which means "choose wisely." Just as President Xi Jinping said, "The path of socialism chosen by China is a choice made by history and by the people."

Language points

1 Since the defeat in the Opium War, China had become prey to Western colonizers empowered by the Industrial Revolution.

become / fall / be prey to: be attacked, cheated, or harmed by sb. bad 受侵犯；受害

Social media users who overshare their lives can become prey to privacy violations and targeted exploitation.

Note: "Easy prey" is another commonly used phrase. For example:

This burglar thought old people were easy prey.

When used as a verb, “prey” is paired with “on” or “upon.” For example:
Cats prey on birds and mice.

2 On May 4, 1919, patriotic students in Beijing took to the streets to protest the government that caved in to the unreasonable demands of imperialist powers after World War I.

take to the streets: when people take to the streets, they express their opposition to sth. in public and often violently 上街游行示威；走上街头
After the controversial decision, citizens took to the streets in peaceful protest.

cave in to: finally stop opposing sth., esp. because sb. has persuaded or threatened you （尤指因某人劝说或威胁而）让步，屈服
After hours of negotiation, he finally caved in to their demands, agreeing to the terms.

3 Early Communist groups started to sprout up in Chinese cities with a large working class.

sprout up: appear suddenly in large numbers 突然大量出现；大量冒出
New ideas began to sprout up as the team brainstormed solutions to the problem.

4 And [the] only thing that draw[s] people together is by addressing [the] majority people’s concern. When you sided with the overwhelming majority of the people, the peasantry, the workers, people in lower [classes], you will get their support.

side with sb.: support one person or group in an argument （在争论中）支持，站在…一边
The committee chose to side with the employees, approving their request for better working conditions.

Note: Some of the interviewees’ expressions are slightly inaccurate (e.g., “draw”→ “draws,” “majority” → “the majority,” “people in lower” → “people in lower classes”). While such informal usage might be understandable in casual conversation – where context and mutual understanding often compensate for minor errors – it’s important for Ss to recognize and use the correct forms in formal or written English. T should remind Ss of these distinctions to help them develop both fluency and accuracy.

Viewing and understanding

Reference answers

2

1) Western colonizers
2) ordinary Chinese
3) a constitutional monarchy
4) a democratic republic

校园资料仓

5) the unreasonable demands

6) Communist groups

7) the official founding

8) surrounding cities from the countryside

9) serves their interests

Intercultural communication skill

Teaching suggestions

This activity aims to enhance Ss' narrative and historical analysis skills by constructing timelines as a universal framework for organizing events. Through chronological reasoning and clear linguistic expression, Ss learn to present historical narratives through timelines, emphasizing clarity, logical progression, and adaptability to diverse audiences.

- Introduce the importance of timelines in storytelling and their universal effectiveness in organizing historical events.
- Emphasize key transition words and phrases like "in [year]," "by [year]," "since," "eventually," etc., and show how they connect events in a timeline. Encourage Ss to practice using these phrases in creating their own historical narratives.
- Use interactive activities where Ss create their own timelines for familiar historical events, combining both visual elements and linguistic transitions. Emphasize clarity and logical sequencing.
- Reinforce the importance of cohesion by ensuring both visual and linguistic elements work together. After presentations, have Ss reflect on how well their timelines convey a clear and engaging story.

***Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

The Communist Party of China (CPC) emerged after the Opium War. Defeated and weakened, China faced exploitation by Western colonizers. Many patriots tried to reform China by adopting Western models like a constitutional monarchy and a democratic republic, but these efforts failed.

The May 4th Movement in 1919 was a turning point. Students protested against the government's submission to imperialists, and the movement spread across China with workers' support. The spread of Marxist ideas following the October Revolution

led revolutionary intellectuals and workers to establish the earliest Communist groups in China.

The CPC was founded in 1921 with just over 50 members. It focused on mobilizing the farmers and workers, who were the majority of China's population. The Party adopted Marxism and developed a unique strategy of surrounding cities from the countryside.

By championing the rights of workers and farmers, the CPC gained their trust and support. As President Xi Jinping has emphasized, the path of socialism chosen by China is a choice made by history and the people. Through its commitment to the majority, the CPC earned the people's confidence and guided China toward independence and prosperity.

Reading

Text: Beyond the oath

Background information

The Communist Party of China (CPC) was founded in 1921 amid immense national challenges, including widespread poverty, internal fragmentation, and foreign exploitation. Over the past century, the Party has led the Chinese people through unyielding struggles, achieving monumental successes:

- In the New Democratic Revolution, bloody battles were fought to liberate the nation;
- Through socialist revolution and construction, self-reliance and tireless efforts built the foundations of a new society;
- By reforming and opening up, transformative modernization was realized through ideological emancipation and determined progress;
- In the new era, historic milestones in socialism with Chinese characteristics have been attained through confidence, self-improvement, and innovation.

Together, the Party and the people have composed the most magnificent chapter in the Chinese nation's millennia-long history.

Notes

In the text, the **highways linking Xizang to the nation's heartbeat** refer to the Sichuan-Xizang Highway and Qinghai-Xizang Highway, which were constructed between April 1950 and December 1954. The highway construction embodies fearlessness, perseverance, and selfless dedication, as builders overcame harsh conditions with unwavering faith and collective strength. It stands as a powerful symbol of military-civilian unity and ethnic solidarity, connecting Xizang to the other parts of China through joint efforts.

***T can guide Ss to study the multimodal annotations in the digital textbook on Ucampus.**

Language points

1 **Brave were those who, shortly after the founding of New China, united with people from various ethnic groups to conquer nature's fiercest obstacles and construct the vital highways linking Xizang to the nation's heartbeat, opening new horizons for development. (Para. 3)**

Note: The structure "Brave were those who ..." employs an inverted syntax (predicate + linking verb + subject) to create a solemn, respectful tone reminiscent of classical literature. By inverting the structure, the sentence begins with "Brave," immediately emphasizing the quality being celebrated. Compared to a neutral structure, "Those who … were brave," the inverted version sounds more timeless and authoritative, positioning the act of bravery as a defining legacy rather than a simple description.

2 **Courageous were those who led groups of ardent individuals to venture into the harsh conditions during the same period, transforming the barren wastelands of Beidahuang into bountiful farmlands that now nourish millions. (Para. 3)**

ardent: *a.* (*usu. before noun*) showing strong positive feelings about an activity and determination to succeed at it 热心的；热切的

She is an ardent supporter of environmental conservation, always advocating for sustainable practices.

barren: *a*. unable to produce plants or fruit 贫瘠的；不毛的

The rocky soil was so barren that even the hardiest plants struggled to survive.

bountiful: *a*.

1) a bountiful area or period of time produces or provides large amounts of sth., esp. food （地域或时期）物产丰富的

The valley was bountiful, yielding abundant crops of wheat and corn every year.

2) large in amount （数量）异常大的

The charity received a bountiful donation from the local community.

Note: In this context, "during the same period" refers to the time shortly after the founding of New China, which is mentioned in the previous sentence. The use of "barren" and "bountiful" creates a striking contrast, highlighting the dramatic transformation of Beidahuang from a desolate wasteland to fertile farmlands, and emphasizing the scale and significance of human effort and resilience.

3 **When natural disasters strike with a vengeance or invisible threats profoundly affect the nation, CPC members rise to the occasion, rallying their fellow citizens to take on any situation. (Para. 3)**

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with a vengeance: with great force or more effort than before 过度地；猛烈地
After the setback, he returned to training with a vengeance, determined to succeed.

rise to the occasion: deal effectively with a difficult situation or problem that happens unexpectedly 得体地应付突如其来的情况
Faced with a sudden flood, the community rose to the occasion by organizing rescue efforts and providing shelter for those affected.

rally:
v. come together, or bring people together, to support an idea, a political party, etc. 集合，召集（以支持某个观点、政党等）
During the flood, community leaders rallied residents to evacuate safely and support relief efforts.
n. [C] a large public meeting, esp. one that is held outdoors to support a political idea, protest, etc. 大型公众集会（尤指为支持某政治观点、抗议等在户外举行的集会）
The rally attracted thousands of supporters who gathered to voice their opinions on climate change.

take on: accept a particular job or responsibility 接受（工作）；承担（责任）
The young entrepreneur was ready to take on the challenge of starting her own business.

4 With a commitment to building a flourishing China, they have navigated the uncharted waters of reform, never afraid to test new ideas. (Para. 4)

Note: In the sentence, the phrase "a commitment to (doing) something" is used to express dedication, determination, and a strong sense of purpose toward a specific goal.
With a commitment to renewable energy, the company invested in solar farms.

5 In only four decades, China's economic output has surged from a modest 1.8 percent of the world's total to an impressive 18 percent. (Para. 5)

Note: In the sentence, the verb "surge" is used to describe a rapid, dramatic increase in China's economic output over a relatively short period (four decades). "Surge" is more vivid than neutral terms like "increase" or "rise." It subtly conveys awe or admiration for the achievement, framing China's economic growth as a remarkable feat.

6 This spirit of bold experimentation has not only revolutionized the economy but also propelled China to the forefront of technological advancement. (Para.6)

Note: The word "propel" is typically followed by prepositions like "into," "to," or "toward," indicating "cause sb. to do an activity or be in a situation." The phrase emphasizes driving somebody or something forward to achieve a significant position or outcome. For example:
Her groundbreaking research in renewable energy has propelled her to the forefront of scientific innovation, earning global recognition.

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7 The Beidou Navigation Satellite System …, and the Chang'e lunar missions … are but two examples. (Para. 6)

Note: Here "but" means "only, merely, or just," emphasizing that the mentioned examples, Beidou and Chang'e lunar missions, are just a small part of China's technological advancements.

8 This sacred commitment, inscribed not merely as a slogan eight decades ago, has since become the beacon for every CPC member. (Para. 7)

Note: The following information explains the background of this sentence: In 1944, eight decades ago, Mao Zedong delivered his speech, "为人民服务," paying tribute to Zhang Side, a soldier who gave his life to save his fellow comrades. In 1945, "serving the people" was included in the Party Constitution for the first time during the Seventh National Congress.

9 It is having the guts to face and conquer challenges, the vision to push the boundaries of progress, and the dedication to serve the people with heart and soul. (Para. 8)

Note: The sentence effectively employs parallel structure to create clarity, balance, and rhetorical impact. Each element follows the same grammatical pattern: [Noun phrase] + [*to* + verb phrase]. Parallelism enhances readability by structuring the sentence with a predictable pattern. The reader can quickly grasp the three components ("... to face, ... to push, ... to serve") without cognitive overload. The rhythmic pattern makes the sentence catchy and memorable, a common technique in speeches or motivational writing. It exemplifies how syntactic consistency can amplify meaning and emotional resonance.

校园资料合

Translation

誓言之上

1 仅在 2023 年，就有超过 200 万中国人庄严地宣誓，加入中国共产党。宣誓仪式上的他们坚定自信，声音洪亮。自最初的五十余位成员起步，中国共产党现已壮大成为世界上最大的执政党，拥有超过 9,900 万党员，领导着 14 亿人口的大国。究竟是什么魅力让一代又一代的人投身于党的怀抱？成为中国共产党党员，肩负起这份重任，其中蕴含的深刻含义又是什么？

2 中国共产党诞生于中国深陷贫困、分裂和外国侵略的危难时刻，自成立之初就肩负起实现民族独立的历史重任。英勇的中国共产党先驱带领中国人民摆脱了压迫，点燃了希望的火种，并迅速传遍整个国家。这种迎难而上、勇于挑战的精神，由一代又一代共产党人传承下来，让他们完成了无数看似不可能完成的使命。

3 在新中国成立之初，这些勇敢的共产党人与各族人民齐心协力，征服自然险阻，修建了生命线公路，把西藏与祖国其他地区连接起来，开辟了发展新天

地。同一时期，无畏的共产党人带领热血志士深入恶劣环境，将荒芜的北大荒改造成了如今养育数百万人的肥沃农田。这种迎难而上的精神同样指引着今天的中国共产党党员，引领他们应对突如其来的危机。当自然灾害肆虐或无形的灾难严重危及国家时，共产党员总是挺身而出，团结广大人民群众迎接一切挑战。中国共产党人一次又一次证明，没有跨不过的高山。他们的坚韧精神和对国家进步的坚定承诺历久弥坚。

4 中国共产党先驱们具有远见卓识，他们开拓创新，开辟通向繁荣的新道路。他们以建设繁荣中国为己任，勇敢探索改革的未知领域，从不畏惧尝试新思想。

5 改革开放的决策为我国社会注入了新的活力，带来了空前的发展。在深圳，昔日简陋的民居已变成令人惊叹的摩天大楼，天际线成为现代化的象征；在浦东，曾经的乡野田地已发展为全球金融中心，赢得国际瞩目。短短四十年间，中国的经济总量从占世界经济总量微不足道的 1.8%跃升至令人瞩目的 18%。

6 这种大胆探索的精神不仅彻底变革了经济格局，还推动我国在科技领域走在前列。北斗导航卫星系统以其精准性在全球竞争中脱颖而出，嫦娥探月工程则在月球背面留下历史性的足迹，这只是其中的两个例子。一代又一代的中国共产党人与创新者们并肩努力，不懈奋斗，将这些科技梦想变为现实。正是由于他们的坚定努力，昨日看似不可能的任务正转化为今日的骄人成就，以及明日的无限可能。

7 在中国共产党先驱们引领中国变革的过程中，一个坚定的信念始终未曾动摇：为人民服务的庄重誓言。这一神圣承诺不仅仅是八十年前的一句口号，自那时起它便成为每一位共产党人前行的灯塔。在中国各地，数以百万计的党员将这一誓言化为实际行动，铸就了党与人民之间牢不可破的纽带。他们是敬业的教师，走出舒适区，将知识的火炬带到偏远地区，点亮年轻的心灵；他们是忠诚的公务员，深入偏远村庄，与当地群众携手制定脱贫方案；他们是富有同情心的医生，夜以继日地工作，为有需要的人提供关键的医疗护理。他们代表党，在各行各业为增进人民福祉而奋斗。中国人民携手并肩，将民族复兴的梦想转化为共同进步的旅程。

8 回望中国共产党的百年历史，共产党员的内核始终清晰可见，那就是勇于面对并战胜挑战的胆识，突破进步边界的远见，以及全心全意为人民服务的奉献精神。无论身处哪个行业，一代又一代的共产党人都为着一个崇高的目标而团结一致：为中国人民谋幸福，为中华民族谋复兴。随着中国迈进新时代，共产党人所秉持的这一承诺将继续激励整个国家迈向共同繁荣以及具有全球意义的辉煌未来。

校阅资料

Reading and understanding

Reference answers

1

3

2

1) a flame of hope
2) conquer nature's fiercest obstacles
3) the barren wastelands
4) invisible threats
5) awe-inspiring skyscrapers
6) a global financial center
7) precision
8) comfort zone
9) tailor-made solutions
10) crucial care

校园资料仓

A. Facing challenges head-on / Rising to any challenges
B. Striving to innovate
C. Serving the people

Intercultural communication skill

Teaching suggestions

This activity helps Ss master the skill of portraying a collective group image by using parallelism and other techniques.

- **Introduce parallelism with contextual examples:** Begin by explaining the concept of parallelism and its role in creating rhythm, balance, and clarity. Use examples from various cultural contexts (such as literature or famous speeches) that highlight characters or groups using parallelism. For example, explore how Martin Luther King Jr. used parallelism in his "I Have a Dream" speech to portray collective unity and shared values.
- **Use parallelism for empathy building:** Focus on the communicative power of parallelism in fostering empathy. Ask Ss to think about how using parallel structures can help bridge cultural gaps, especially when portraying groups that may be unfamiliar to an audience. Provide scenarios where parallelism can be used to describe a group of people, such as a political party or an international

community, emphasizing how it can humanize them and make their values relatable to international audiences.

- **Create character profiles using parallelism:** Encourage Ss to work in pairs or small groups to choose a group of people (from history, literature, or a fictional group) and describe their collective qualities using parallel structure.
- **Analyze characters in the text:** In the specific text about the CPC, break down how parallelism is used to portray different members of the group with shared qualities like bravery, courage, and commitment. Ask Ss to analyze the choice of adjectives and how the structure "Adjective + were + those who ..." conveys the collective spirit of the CPC. Then, compare these qualities to groups in other cultures, encouraging Ss to draw similarities or differences in how collective traits are portrayed using parallelism.

*** Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

3

What magnetic force draws so many to the Party, generation after generation? What profound meaning lies in taking on the role of a CPC member, and shouldering the responsibility that comes with it?

Shenzhen's humble dwellings have become awe-inspiring skyscrapers, its skyline now rising as a symbol of modernity; Pudong's once-rural fields have blossomed into a global financial center, commanding international admiration.

They are the dedicated teachers who venture beyond their comfort zone, carrying the torch of knowledge to illuminate young minds in remote areas. They are the loyal civil servants who immerse themselves in crafting tailor-made solutions alongside locals in remote villages to eliminate poverty. They are the compassionate doctors who work countless sleepless nights to provide crucial care to those in need.

It is having the guts to face and conquer challenges, the vision to push the boundaries of progress, and the dedication to serve the people with heart and soul.

4

A group of CPC members I am familiar with are those in my community who organized volunteer service teams to address the needs of the people. Compassionate were those who visited villages and households, attentively listening to residents' concerns and resolving their issues. Tireless were those who initiated activities such as fraud prevention campaigns, legal consultations, and elderly care services, ensuring support was provided where it was most needed. Their efforts exemplify the CPC's unwavering commitment to serving the people, delivering meaningful actions that resonate deeply within the community. By forming specialized teams and adopting

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innovative service methods, these CPC members embody resilience, selflessness, and a profound sense of responsibility to enhance the lives of the residents.

Language in focus

Reference answers

1

1 magnetic

2 guts

3 conquered

4 illuminated

5 ardent

6 oppression

7 loyal

8 ignited

2

1 carry the torch

2 take on

3 blossomed into

4 have ventured into

5 stand tall

3

Since its founding, the CPC has served as the guiding light for the Chinese people. Growing from just over 50 members to 99 million, the CPC leads Chinese people with unwavering determination on the path to national rejuvenation and shared prosperity. Party members from all walks of life uphold the Party's pioneering spirit, demonstrate courage in innovation, and rise to challenges. They serve the people with heart and soul, forging an unbreakable bond between the Party and the people.

Critical thinking

Sample answers

1

The CPC's approach to addressing challenges has evolved significantly over time. In its early years, the Party focused on national liberation, uniting people to overcome external threats and internal divisions. After the founding of the People's Republic of

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China, the CPC directed its efforts toward building a new socialist country, overcoming the obstacles posed by economic underdevelopment and social inequalities. In the more recent decades, the Party has led the country to embrace reform and opening up, fostering innovation and technological advancement. This evolution showcases the Party's ability to adapt its strategies in response to changing national and global contexts. The leadership's willingness to adjust its policies – from revolutionary struggles to economic reforms – demonstrates a pragmatic approach that prioritizes national progress. The CPC's leadership shows an understanding of the importance of evolution, using past experiences to guide future challenges while maintaining a steady focus on the welfare of the people.

2

The transformation of places like Shenzhen and Pudong has profoundly impacted young people in China by offering them new opportunities for education, employment, and entrepreneurship. As these cities have evolved into hubs of technology, business, and innovation, they have attracted a generation eager to build careers in dynamic industries. The rapid economic growth has opened doors for young professionals to contribute to China's technological advancements and global competitiveness. This transformation also suggests that young people in China play a crucial role in shaping the country's future by driving innovation, participating in the digital economy, and embracing new models of work and education. With access to modern infrastructures and resources, today's young people are empowered to push the boundaries of what is possible, helping the nation reach new heights in economic development and global influence.

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3

The CPC's commitment to serving the people is clearly reflected in its efforts to improve education and support community programs. For example, the Party's dedication to selecting and supporting teachers to remote areas to educate young people or mobilizing resources for poverty alleviation in rural communities demonstrates its focus on addressing the needs of society's most vulnerable. These efforts align with the CPC's belief in empowering individuals and uplifting the nation as a whole.

On a personal level, this principle can inspire one to pursue careers that directly contribute to public welfare, whether in education, healthcare, or social services. By following the Party's example, individuals can contribute to national rejuvenation by creating opportunities for others, fostering a spirit of collaboration, and ensuring that all citizens have access to the resources needed to succeed. This collective mindset strengthens the country and advances the broader goal of prosperity for all.

Exploring the world

In Understanding China, we explored the remarkable achievements of the Communist Party of China in leading the Chinese people to develop the country. This illustrates the significant role political parties play in ensuring the well-being of the people and the prosperity of the country. But what exactly is a political party, and how does it operate? Exploring the world introduces diverse political party systems around the world, with a particular focus on how they are shaped by national circumstances, history, and culture.

The key teaching objectives lie in exploring the characteristics of different political systems and helping Ss understand the relationship between political systems and national conditions.

The text is a platform for fostering mutual learning and exchange between civilizations. T can encourage Ss to recognize the advantages of different political systems and encourage them to respect different political systems while boosting confidence in their own system.

Notes

*** T can guide Ss to study the multimodal annotations in the digital textbook on Ucampus.**

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Text: The spectrum of world political party systems

Language points

1 Some countries have only one political party, while many others have anywhere from several to a dozen. (Para. 1)

anywhere from / between … to / and …: used for saying that a number or amount is within a particular range, when you cannot give a single exact figure 大约

The journey can take anywhere from 20 minutes to an hour.
She was one of those women who could be anywhere between 45 and 60.

Note: The expression is effective in conveying approximation and variability in a concise, relatable way. It contrasts sharply with "only one," emphasizing the diversity of political systems while maintaining flexibility for real-world complexity.

2 Some countries implement a one-party system, where a single political party holds the reins over the long term. (Para. 2)

hold the reins: be in control 掌管；掌握

As the team leader, it's your responsibility to hold the reins and ensure the project stays on track.

3 In some countries, they are banned by law from even forming or being active, while in others they may be allowed to exist and operate but are not entrusted with any actual political clout. (Para. 2)

clout: *n.* [C] (*infml.*) power or the authority to influence other people's decisions（影响他人决定的）力量，权势

Despite his young age, he has already gained enough clout to influence major decisions in the company.

Note: In the sentence, the phrase "not entrusted with any actual political clout" underscores that while these parties may be allowed to operate, they don't have the power to shape decisions, policies, or governance. Their existence is symbolic or nominal, not functional.

4 While some one-party states have undergone political changes since the 1970s, others have continued to maintain the one-party model, adapting it to their unique historical and social contexts. (Para. 2)

Note: During the late 1960s and early 1970s, a wave of coups swept through one-party states in Africa, and some one-party states transitioned into multiparty systems.

5 These two parties are on equal footing, differing only in terms of who is in power and who is in opposition. (Para. 3)

on (an) equal footing: with the same rights and conditions as the people you are competing with 条件相同的；互不占优势的

The new trade agreement ensures that all participating members can compete on equal footing.

Note: The phrase "on equal footing" underscores the formal equality of political parties within a system, emphasizing that their roles (power vs. opposition) do not diminish their institutional legitimacy. The phrase avoids simplistic binaries (e.g., "winners vs. losers") by framing the parties' relationship as coequal, despite their differing roles.

6 Though adversaries, they may cooperate in governance under special circumstances. (Para. 3)

adversary: *n.* [C] (*fml.*) a country or person you are fighting or competing against 对手；敌手

In the realm of international diplomacy, former adversaries can become allies when faced with a common threat, such as climate change or global health crises.

Note: The structure "though adversaries" is an elliptical form, and the complete expression could be "though they are adversaries." More examples of elliptical form:
Whether (it is) true or false, the story is interesting.
While (he was) at college, he was a prominent athlete.

7 These parties engage in centripetal competition, fostering political structures that encourage working hand in glove. (Para. 4)

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centripetal: *a.* (of a turning object) moving toward the point around which it is turning 向心的

Note: In this context, "centripetal" is used metaphorically to describe a unifying or cohesion-building dynamic in political competition. The opposite of "centripetal" is "centrifugal," which describes forces that push groups apart.

hand in glove: if you work hand in glove with sb., you work very closely with them 密切合作

The research team and the engineering department operated hand in glove throughout the project, ensuring that innovative ideas were translated into practical solutions.

Note: The phrase evokes the image of two hands wearing gloves, moving in perfect unison. It typically means working together closely and effectively, often to do something dishonest. For example:
They worked hand in glove to cover up the scandal.

In this context, it is used positively to highlight constructive cooperation.

8 China's political party system extensively and unfailingly represents the fundamental interests of the broadest masses, and pools ideas and suggestions to ensure informed and democratic decision-making. (Para. 5)

Note: The word "pool" is a transitive verb, meaning "collect, combine, or aggregate resources, ideas, or efforts from multiple sources into a unified whole." In this context, it describes how China's political system gathers diverse ideas and suggestions from the masses to inform decision-making. It suggests how China's political system is both representative (serving the people) and procedurally inclusive (gathering diverse ideas), embodying a model of effective and people-centered governance.

9 In a word, an effective political party system aligns with a country's national conditions and social and historical context, and is conducive to political stability, the well-being of the people, and the improvement of productivity. (Para. 6)

align with: be the same or similar, or agree with each other 保持一致

A system that aligns with a country's traditions, economic needs, and cultural values is more likely to succeed than one imposed without consideration for local realities.

Note: In this context, it specifies that a system must fit in or correspond to a country's national conditions, social dynamics, and historical context to function effectively. This choice emphasizes flexibility and pragmatism, rejecting rigid models in favor of governance tailored to local realities.

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Translation

世界政党制度

1 在当今世界，除了约 20 个国家外，基本上所有国家都有政党。有的国家只有一个政党，而许多其他国家则有几个到十几个不等。政党参与国家政治生活所形成的制度性政党关系、行为规则和运行机制构成一个国家的政党制度，并对社会产生深刻影响。一个国家究竟采取何种政党制度，取决于其国情和历史文化传统。

2 有的国家实行一党制。一党制是指一个国家长期由一个政党掌握政权的政党制度。在这种制度下，其他政党的法律地位各不相同。有的国家除执政党外的其他政党在法律上均被禁止，不能合法地存在和活动；有的国家虽允许其他政党存在和活动，但不允许其参与政权。一党制下的执政党通常产生于民族国家建立前，肩负着对抗外国殖民统治和争取国家独立的任务。这种情况下通常需要一个强大的政党来实现国家的统一并执行集中的领导。在实现国家独立后，这个政党就自然而然地成为主导政治力量，从而形成一党制。一党制能够在一定时期内带来政治稳定。虽然 20 世纪 70 年代以来，部分一党制国家经历了政治变革，但仍有部分国家基于自身独特的历史传统和社会条件，通过制度调适与完善，继续维系着一党制。

3 有的国家实行两党制，其特点是由两个主要政党轮流掌握政权。这两个政党地位平等，它们之间的唯一区别在于谁执政，谁在野。他们轮流执政，在国家政治体制中长期占据主导地位。尽管是对手，但如果遇到特殊情况，它们也会联合执政。目前，美国、英国、加拿大、新西兰、澳大利亚等国实行两党制。英国既是两党制最突出的代表，也是其发源地。英国的两党制形成于 17 世纪议会内的冲突，是由阶级冲突推动并加剧的政治权力两极化的结果。两党制有其灵活性和机动性，但执政党有时并不总是代表大多数公众的意见，并且两党之间的不同观点也可能导致政策和立法反复。

4 有的国家实行多党制。在这种制度下，三个或更多的政党并存，其中一些政党联合组成多数派联盟以掌握政权。法国是最早实行多党制的国家之一。1789 年法国大革命后，派系斗争迅速增加。随着 1870 年法国第三共和国的建立，这些派系斗争演变为政党斗争，逐渐形成了多党制。从那时起，法国经历了多次政权更迭，但多党制始终是其政治体系的一个重要特征。目前，大多数欧洲国家实行多党制。根据政党的意识形态差距，一些学者将多党制分为温和多党制和极化多党制。在德国和比利时等国家，有三到五个政党，其意识形态差距相对较小。这些政党之间是向心式竞争，形成了鼓励密切合作的政治结构。这种政治体制被称为温和多党制。在意大利和法国等其他国家，有六到八个或更多政党，其意识形态差距较大。在这些体制中，一个或多个政党发挥着重要作用，导致更加竞争和分裂的政治格局。这被称为极化多党制。

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5 中国实行的是中国共产党领导的多党合作和政治协商制度，与上述政党体制均不相同。在中国多党合作制度下，中国共产党行使国家权力，其他政党在其领导下充分参与国家事务的管理。 执政党和参政党实行“长期共存、互相监督、肝胆相照、荣辱与共”的基本方针。中国新型政党制度广泛、持久地代表最广大人民的根本利益，集中各方面的意见和建议，实现决策的科学化和民主化，同时它团结各界力量朝着共同目标前进。这一独特的政党制度为世界政党制度提供了“中国方案”。

6 正如《中国新型政党制度》（白皮书）所言：“一个国家实行什么样的政党制度，是由这个国家的历史传统和现实国情决定的。世界政党制度具有多样性，没有也不可能有普遍适用于各国的政党制度。”各国政党制度的差异体现了人类文明发展的多样性。总之，有效的政党制度需要符合本国国情与社会历史条件，且利于政局稳定、人民幸福和生产力提高。

Reading and understanding

Reference answers

1

1) A single political party
2) national independence
3) political stability
4) on equal footing
5) the majority of public opinion
6) reversed
7) unite to form a majority coalition
8) centripetal competition
9) competitive and fragmented
10) state power
11) the fundamental interests
12) a “Chinese solution”

2

1 F

[Corrected: In some countries, they are banned by law from even forming or being active, while in others they may be allowed to exist and operate but are not entrusted with any actual political clout.]

2 T

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3 F

[Corrected: With the establishment of the French Third Republic in 1870, the fractional struggles evolved into party struggles, leading to the formation of a multiparty system.]

4 F

[Corrected: In a multiparty system with moderate pluralism, political parties tend to have relatively small ideological differences.]

5 T

6 T

Language in focus

1 Complete the paragraph with the correct form of the words given below.

adversary	diversity	entrust	extensively
mechanism	moderate	rein	wield

In a team, diverse perspectives and experiences are often considered valuable assets. However, managing such 1) _____ can be challenging, as it often requires balancing conflicting viewpoints while fostering inclusivity. To address this, an effective 2) _____ must be established to ensure collaboration and clear communication.

Team leaders must 3) _____ responsibilities thoughtfully, delegating tasks to capable members. At the same time, they need to hold the 4) _____ to maintain order and ensure the team stays focused on its goals. When disagreements arise, it is crucial to recognize that those with differing opinions are not 5) _____ but contributors to diverse perspectives and potential solutions.

By 6) _____ their power carefully, the leader can guide discussions to remain productive and ensure that decisions are made in a(n) 7) _____ and balanced manner. Furthermore, by fostering an environment where ideas are explored 8) _____, the team can unlock its full potential, overcome challenges, and achieve meaningful objectives.

Reference answers

1) diversity

2) mechanism

3) entrust

4) reins

5) adversaries

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6) wielding

7) moderate

8) extensively

2 Complete the paragraph with the correct form of the phrases from the text that are similar in meaning to the expressions in parentheses.

Governments that 1)_____(make a determined effort to achieve) equality in society must ensure that all citizens are treated 2)_____(with the same rights and opportunities), regardless of their background or status. Those

3)_____(having control or authority) bear the responsibility to address societal inequalities and promote shared prosperity. To fulfill this responsibility, they must design policies that 4)_____(be consistent with) the principles of fairness and inclusivity, ensuring the needs of all citizens are met. Furthermore, political leaders and institutions must work 5)_____(closely and harmoniously), so that they can create an environment that 6)_____(be helpful or likely to produce) growth and progress, fostering unity and sustainable development.

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Reference answers

1) strive for

2) on equal footing

3) in power

4) align with

5) hand in glove

6) is conducive to

Roundtable discussion

Sample answers

China's political party system is considered a "Chinese solution" to global political party systems due to its distinctive characteristics and advantages.

Relationship between political parties

China's political party system fosters unity and collaboration among various political parties and non-affiliated individuals. Instead of engaging in partisan competition or opposition for the sake of opposing, this system encourages all parties to work together toward the shared goal of national rejuvenation. This approach effectively avoids the pitfalls of single-party systems lacking oversight and two-party or multiparty systems being plagued by destructive rivalry, offering a balanced and cooperative model for governance.

Interests represented by political parties

China's political party system is designed to genuinely, broadly, and sustainably represent the fundamental interests of the majority of the people. By consolidating opinions and suggestions from all sectors of society, it ensures that decision-making is both scientific and democratic. This prevents the issues seen in some other political systems, where parties represent narrow interests, such as partisan, class, regional, or group interests, and engage in divisive politics, leading to indecision and social fragmentation.

Impact on society and human well-being

China's political party system has made significant contributions to societal stability and human well-being. It has enabled the country to achieve remarkable progress in areas such as poverty alleviation, economic development, and social equity, and improved living standards for its people.

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Communicating with the world

Additional notes

The body section contains the essence of an argumentative essay as it presents the main arguments and evidence supporting the thesis. To develop the body section in a meaningful way, T can guide Ss to divide their arguments into two key components: the historical perspective and the people's perspective, aligning their arguments with the essay title for greater depth and clarity.

Historical perspective: Encourage Ss to highlight the CPC's pivotal role in significant historical events. Guide Ss to focus on key milestones such as the War of Resistance Against Japanese Aggression, the founding of the People's Republic of China, and also reform and opening-up policies. Example sentences:

Historically, the CPC played a pivotal role in ...

The CPC's leadership during [specific event] demonstrates its ability to ...

People's perspective: Emphasize the CPC's focus on addressing the needs of the people. Encourage Ss to include examples like poverty alleviation programs, economic modernization, and improvements in social welfare. Example sentences:

The CPC has consistently prioritized the needs of the people by ...

Through initiatives such as [specific example], the CPC has gained the trust and support of the population.

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T can remind Ss to pay attention to the use of timelines, presenting historical events in chronological order to ensure clarity and logical progression. Additionally, T can remind Ss to use rhetorical devices to make their writing more compelling. For example, analogies (e.g., "The CPC's role in modernization mirrors a ship's rudder in navigating turbulent waters") can be used to engage readers, and parallelism can be employed to emphasize key points.

For evaluation, consider the following perspectives:

- **Content:** Does the evidence (historical, statistical, expert) directly support the thesis?
- **Structure:** Is the argument logically sequenced? Does each paragraph contribute to the thesis with clear topic sentences and evidence?
- **Language:** Is the language persuasive yet precise? Are rhetorical devices used effectively to enhance impact?
- **Communication:** Does the essay explain complex ideas (e.g., socialist market economy) in globally accessible terms? Does it avoid cultural assumptions while respecting the topic's sensitivity?

*** Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

The 20th century marked a tumultuous era for China, characterized by foreign invasions, feudal oppression, and societal fragmentation. Amid these crises, the Communist Party of China (CPC) emerged as a unifying force, leading the nation toward independence and prosperity. The leadership of the CPC represents both a historical inevitability and the collective choice of the Chinese people.

Historically, the CPC's legitimacy stems from its ability to resolve the nation's most pressing crises and steer the nation toward stability. After the Opium War in the 1840s, China became prey to Western colonizers, and the nation was struggling with the three oppressive forces of imperialism, feudalism, and bureaucrat-capitalism. Through the Northern Expedition, the Agrarian Revolutionary War, the War of Resistance Against Japanese Aggression, and the War of Liberation, the CPC led the people to overthrow the three mountains and established the People's Republic of China, marking the end of China's century of humiliation and the dawn of national independence and development. From the people's perspective, the CPC has consistently prioritized the well-being of its citizens, earning the trust and support of the population. In 1978, China launched its reform and opening-up policy, which propelled the nation's GDP to unprecedented levels and significantly improved people's living standards. By the end of 2020, the CPC had eradicated absolute poverty, lifting 99 million people in rural areas out of poverty – a feat unmatched in scale and speed. Life expectancy rose from 35 years in 1949 to 78 years today, reflecting advancements in healthcare, infrastructure, and social welfare.

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In conclusion, the CPC's leadership is no accident of history but the culmination of its ability to deliver stability, prosperity, and dignity. As China strides toward national rejuvenation, the CPC remains the steadfast choice of its people – a testament to its enduring legitimacy and vision.

Self-reflection

Understanding China	1	I can list the crises China faced in the early 20th century.
	2	I can explain the reason why the CPC was able to lead the Chinese people in founding the People's Republic of China.
	3	I can explain what it means to be a CPC member.
	4	I can list the ways that the CPC employed to lead the Chinese people in realizing the goals of national rejuvenation.
Exploring the world	1	I can list the major political party systems in the world.
	2	I can explain the characteristics of different political party systems.
Communicating with the world	1	I used timelines in my essay.
	2	I used parallelism and examples in my essay.